BOARD MEETING DATE: May 6, 2011 AGENDA NO. 5

PROPOSAL: Issue Purchase Order for Calibration Gas Dilution Systems and Primary Ozone Standard

SYNOPSIS: In November 5, 2010, the Board approved the release of an RFQ for the acquisition of six Calibration Gas Dilution Systems for use in ambient air monitoring calibrations as budgeted in the 19^{th} year PAMS Program. A review panel was convened to evaluate the three bids received, and Teledyne-API was selected as the recommended vendor. The purchase of a Primary Ozone Standard was also included in the 19^{th} year PAMS Budget, and an informal bid process resulted in the selection of Tanabyte Engineering. This action is to issue a purchase order to Teledyne-API to purchase two NCore ready dilution systems and four ambient dilution systems at a total cost not to exceed $85,310. This action is also to issue a purchase order for one Primary Ozone Standard at a cost not to exceed $8,341 from Tanabyte Engineering.

COMMITTEE: Administrative, April 8, 2011; Recommended for Approval

RECOMMENDED ACTION:
Authorize the Procurement Manager to

a. Execute a purchase order with Teledyne-API for the purchase of six Calibration Gas Dilution systems for an amount not to exceed $85,310; and
b. Execute a purchase order with Tanabyte Engineering for the purchase of one Ozone Primary Standard for an amount not to exceed $8,341.

Barry R. Wallerstein, D.Env.
Executive Officer

CSL:PMF:DS:cv

Background

<u>Calibration Gas Dilution Systems</u>

Gas Calibration Dilution Systems are deployed in all air monitoring stations to dilute standard gases to known levels in order to perform automated span and precision checks of air quality monitoring equipment. They are also utilized by staff in calibration, repair, quality assurance, and the laboratory. The current inventory of Gas Calibration Systems includes many aging systems that are no longer supported by the manufacturers, and these systems are in need of replacement. Furthermore, at least two, more sophisticated Gas Calibration Systems are needed to meet the new U.S. EPA National Core Network (NCore) monitoring requirements. NCore is U.S. EPA's recent monitoring requirement for a few select air monitoring stations to be fully instrumented with capabilities for trace-level measurements of SO2, CO and NOx. The trace-level equipment requires enhanced calibration capabilities. In November 2010, the release of RFQ #Q2011-03 for six (6) Gas Calibration Systems was authorized by the Board under the 19th year PAMS Budget. Three responses to the RFQ were received and reviewed.

<u>Primary Ozone Standard</u>

The AQMD uses a Primary Ozone Standard configured in accordance with U.S. EPA 40 CFR Part 50 to provide traceable calibration to the District's network of ozone monitors. Once each year this unit is compared with a regional Standard Reference Photometer for verification. The current Ozone Standard is more than ten years old and is not supported by the manufacturer as the company is now out of business. Therefore, there is a need for a new, cost-effective, Primary Ozone Standard unit that has the ability to perform automated certification functions and to create digital certification reports for quality assurance purposes. An amount of $9,000 was budgeted in the 19th year PAMS award for the purchase of a new Primary Ozone Standard.

Bid Evaluations

<u>Calibration Gas Dilution Systems</u>

At the close of the solicitation on December 7, 2010, three quotations were received. An evaluation panel was convened to evaluate the bids. The four-member panel consisted of an Air Quality Specialist from CARB, a Monitoring Division Manager from Ventura County APCD, an AQMD Air Quality Chemist, and a Senior Air Quality Instrument Specialist. The panel's ethnicity and gender breakdown was as follows: three Caucasian and one Hispanic-American; all male.

Bids were scored based on meeting technical specifications and cost. The bids submitted by Teledyne-API received the highest scores based on the scoring criteria for both the purposes of NCore and the ambient network. The average score was 90.9 out of 100 for the NCore specifications and 87.5 out of 100 for ambient network use. The scores for the other bidders were 80.5 (NCore) and 82.1 (ambient) from Environics, Inc. and 81.8 (ambient) from Thermo Fisher Scientific, Inc. Thermo Fisher did not submit a separate bid for NCore nor did their standard ambient unit meet those enhanced technical specifications.

<u>Primary Ozone Standard</u>

Informal bids and corresponding technical specifications were considered for the purchase of the Primary Ozone Standard. Three quotations were received. The Tanabyte Engineering instrument was selected as they were the only unit designed from the ground up to be a Primary Standard with onboard software to create certification reports. The other units evaluated were retrofitted standard ozone monitors. Although Tanabyte did not submit the lowest price bid, they included these additional features at a cost only $225 more than the lowest bid.

Proposal

Staff is recommending that the Board approve the execution of a purchase order with Teledyne-API for an amount not to exceed of $85,310 for the purchase of six gas dilution systems. This amount is based upon the bid received in response to RFQ #Q2011-03. Staff is also recommending that the Board approve the execution of a purchase order with Tanabyte Engineering for an amount not to exceed $8,341 for the purchase of one Primary Ozone Standard based on an informal bid evaluation. Complete evaluation results are provided in the Attachment 1.

Outreach

In accordance with AQMD's Procurement Policy and Procedure, a public notice advertising the RFQ and inviting bids was published in the Los Angeles Times, the Orange County Register, the San Bernardino Sun, and Riverside County Press Enterprise newspapers to leverage the most cost-effective method of outreach to the entire South Coast Basin.

Additionally, potential bidders may have been notified utilizing AQMD's own electronic listing of certified minority vendors. Notice of the RFQ has been mailed to the Black and Latino Legislative Caucuses and various minority chambers of commerce and business associations, the State of California Contracts Register website, and placed on the Internet at AQMD's website (http://www.aqmd.gov). Information was also available on AQMD's bidder's 24-hour telephone message line (909) 396-2724.

Resource Impacts

The proposed expenditures for this equipment are under the amounts originally budgeted for this purpose in the 19th year PAMS award, a grant funded externally by U.S. EPA, as detailed in the November 2010 Board Letter.

Attachment

1. Evaluation Result

ATTACHMENT 1
Evaluation Results

Gas Dilution Systems (Ambient Stations)

Quotation Evaluation Criteria	**Environics**	**Teledyne**	**Thermo Fisher**
Technical	59.0	57.5	53.0
Cost	23.1	30.0	28.8
Total Score	**82.1**	**87.5**	**81.8**

Gas Dilution Systems (NCORE Stations)

Quotation Evaluation Criteria	**Environics**	**Teledyne**	**Thermo Fisher**
Technical	50.5	63.0	NA*
Cost	30.0	27.9	NA*
Total Score	**80.5**	**90.9**	**NA***

*It was determined by the panel that Thermo Fisher did not meet the minimum technical specifications for use with NCORE.